



LOGLINE

When Atlanta's most feared food critic discovers her scathing review destroyed her ex-fiancé's restaurant, they're forced to collaborate on a viral video series that becomes a recipe for second chances, family healing, and finding love in the most unexpected kitchen.

TONE

"Chef's Table" meets *"When Harry Met Sally"* with the authentic soul of *"Queen Sugar"* and the aspirational food culture of *"The Bear"*, a warm, emotional, visually sumptuous, but grounded in real Atlanta culture and genuine human connection.

THEME

Healing generational wounds through authentic connection. The story explores how food becomes a language for love, forgiveness, and cultural identity, while examining what it means to build something real in a world that often rewards performance over truth.

PITCH

In the heart of Atlanta's evolving food scene, two former lovers must navigate past betrayal, family secrets, and their own emotional walls to save a restaurant and possibly each other. This isn't just about cooking; it's about the courage to be vulnerable, the power of authentic cultural expression, and how the right recipe can heal generations of pain. With Atlanta as our vibrant backdrop and food as our universal language, *Southern (Dis)Comfort* serves up a love story that's as satisfying as Sunday dinner and as complex as the city that inspired it.

DETAILED SYNOPSIS

ACT I: Jasmine "Jaz" Carter, Atlanta's most influential food critic, publishes a devastating review that destroys The Peach Pit, an upscale Southern restaurant. When she discovers the owner is Marcus Grant, her ex-fiancé who left her three days before their wedding. Both of their careers hang in the balance. Forced into a month-long collaboration for a viral video series, they must navigate their painful past while trying to save his restaurant.

ACT II: As Jaz learns to cook and Marcus confronts his fear of vulnerability, their chemistry reignites. But when Jaz discovers her estranged father Leonard has been Marcus's secret investor, manipulating their reunion from behind the scenes, she feels betrayed by both men. Enter celebrity chef Darius King, offering Jaz everything Marcus can't: success, stability, and freedom from her complicated past.

ACT III: Marcus doesn't fight for Jaz with grand gestures, but by finally being honest about his failures and fears. When their collaborative cooking video goes viral for all the wrong reasons, they must decide whether to play it safe or risk everything for authentic connection. The resolution comes not through competition, but through community, as they transform The Peach Pit into a space where food tells stories and heals wounds.

CHARACTER BREAKDOWN

JASMINE "JAZ" CARTER (32) - *Lead Female* Atlanta's most feared food critic. Sharp, sophisticated, emotionally guarded. Uses her pen as both sword and shield. Carries abandonment trauma from her father leaving and struggles with vulnerability. Her journey is learning to create rather than just critique.

MARCUS GRANT (34) - *Lead Male*

Chef/owner of The Peach Pit. Talented but insecure, haunted by past business failure. Left Jaz because he felt unworthy, now must learn that love requires showing up even when you're not perfect. Represents authentic Southern cuisine with modern sensibility.

RUBY WASHINGTON (65) - *Supporting Lead* Head chef and Marcus's surrogate mother. Survived Jim Crow, integration, and gentrification. The moral center who teaches that cooking is about feeding souls, not egos. Becomes Jaz's unexpected mentor in both cooking and life.

LEONARD CARTER (58) - *Antagonist/Father Figure* Jaz's estranged father. Successful businessman who left when Jaz was 12 during her mother's cancer battle. Tries to buy his way back into her life through Marcus's restaurant. Complex villain driven by guilt and love.

LOLA SINGH (29) - *Best Friend* Jaz's wine expert best friend. Bubbly exterior hiding imposter syndrome in Atlanta's predominantly white wine world. Provides comic relief and emotional support while navigating her own romance with Marcus's sous chef.

DARIUS KING (35) - *Romantic Rival* Celebrity chef returning to Atlanta. Charming, successful, represents the safe choice for Jaz. Not villainous, but ultimately wrong for her because he doesn't challenge her growth.

TALENT SUGGESTIONS

JASMINE CARTER: Regina King, Issa Rae, or Kiki Layne *Need: Sophisticated, sharp, vulnerable beneath the surface*

MARCUS GRANT: Michael B. Jordan, LaKeith Stanfield, or John David Washington
Need: Masculine but sensitive, natural chemistry with lead

RUBY WASHINGTON: Aunjanue Ellis, Angela Bassett, or Phylicia Rashad *Need: Maternal wisdom, commanding screen presence*

LEONARD CARTER: Forest Whitaker, Mahershala Ali, or Jeffrey Wright *Need: Complex antagonist, paternal authority*

LOLA SINGH: Mindy Kaling, Lilly Singh, or Freida Pinto *Need: Comedic timing, supportive friend energy*

DARIUS KING: Omari Hardwick, Jay Ellis, or Kofi Siriboe *Need: Charismatic, non-threatening rival*

SOUTHERN DISCOMFORT

JASMINE
CARTER



Regina King



KiKi Layne

MARCUS
GRANT



Michael B. Jordan



LaKeith Stanfield

RUBY
WASHINGTON



Angela Bassett



Phylicia Rashad

LEONARD
CARTER



Forest Whitaker



Lilly Singh

DARIUS
KING



DIRECTOR MATCH SUGGESTIONS

NIA DaCOSTA - *Perfect tonal match* - Proven with ensemble pieces, understands character-driven narratives, strong with both intimate moments and broader social themes.

BARRY JENKINS - *Prestige option* - Visual poetry, authentic cultural storytelling, exceptional with emotional intimacy and complex character relationships.

STELLA MEGHIE - *Rising star* - Specializes in romantic dramedies, strong with female-driven narratives, proven track record with streaming content.

SHAKA KING - *Bold choice* - Brings authenticity and political awareness, excellent with ensemble casts, could elevate the cultural commentary aspects.

LOOKBOOK & MOOD REFERENCES

Visual Style:

- "Chef's Table" - Gorgeous food cinematography, intimate kitchen moments
- "Atlanta" (FX) - Authentic Atlanta locations, cultural specificity
- "Queen Sugar" - Warm, golden hour lighting, family dynamics
- "The Bear" - Kitchen energy, professional stakes, emotional authenticity

Color Palette:

- Warm golds and deep browns (Southern comfort)
- Fresh greens and peach tones (farm-to-table aesthetic)
- Rich burgundy and cream (sophisticated romance)

Key Visual Elements:

- Steam rising from cast iron skillets
 - Golden hour light through restaurant windows
 - Close-ups of hands working ingredients
 - Atlanta skyline transitions between scenes
-

MARKETING HOOKS & TAGLINES

Primary Tagline: *"Some recipes are worth perfecting."*

Alternative Options:

- *"The heart wants what the heart wants... even if it's complicated."*
- *"Love is the secret ingredient."*
- *"Sometimes you have to go back to move forward."*

Marketing Hooks:

- **Food Porn Appeal** - Gorgeous cooking sequences and Atlanta restaurant culture
 - **#RelationshipGoals** - Second chance romance with genuine emotional stakes
 - **Cultural Authenticity** - Real Atlanta, real Southern food culture
 - **Social Media Ready** - Built-in cooking content, behind-the-scenes kitchen moments
 - **Holiday Programming** - Perfect for Valentine's Day, Mother's Day, Thanksgiving windows
-

TARGET AUDIENCE & MARKET

Primary Audience: Adults 25-54, 60% female

- Foodie culture enthusiasts
- Romantic comedy fans seeking depth
- Viewers who appreciate authentic cultural storytelling
- Streaming audiences hungry for diverse content

Secondary Audience:

- Cooking show crossover viewers
- Southern culture enthusiasts
- Second-chance romance demographic
- Social media food content consumers

Tertiary Audience:

- Awards consideration voters (screenplay, ensemble acting)
 - International markets (universal themes, food culture export)
-

WHY IT SELLS

- 1. PROVEN GENRE FUSION:** Combines two of streaming's hottest categories - food content and romantic comedy - with authentic cultural storytelling.
 - 2. ATLANTA AUTHENTICITY:** Genuine representation of Atlanta's food scene and Black Southern culture, appealing to both local and national audiences.
 - 3. SOCIAL MEDIA NATIVE:** Built-in shareable content through cooking sequences, restaurant culture, and relationship moments.
 - 4. AWARDS POTENTIAL:** Original screenplay, ensemble acting, and cultural authenticity position it for awards consideration.
 - 5. FRANCHISE POSSIBILITIES:** Could spawn cooking shows, companion series, or limited series exploring supporting characters.
 - 6. HOLIDAY PROGRAMMING:** Perfect for multiple seasonal programming windows throughout the year.
-

COMPARABLE FILMS & SERIES

Tone/Style:

- *"The Half of It"* - Authentic emotional storytelling, cultural specificity
- *"Always Be My Maybe"* - Food culture, second chance romance, ensemble cast
- *"Chef's Table: Pizza"* - Food as cultural expression and personal story

Commercial Success:

- *"Set It Up"* (Netflix) - Rom-com that became streaming phenomenon
- *"The Kissing Booth"* franchise - Proof of streaming rom-com audience appetite
- *"To All the Boys"* series - Cultural authenticity driving mainstream success

Cultural Impact:

- *"Crazy Rich Asians"* - Authentic cultural representation in mainstream rom-com
 - *"Queen Sugar"* - Southern family dynamics and generational healing themes
-

PRODUCTION VALUE

Budget Range: \$2.5 - 5 Million (Low-budget with high production values)

Key Value Drivers:

- Atlanta tax incentives and local filming support
- Food styling and cinematography expertise
- Authentic restaurant locations and kitchen sets
- Strong ensemble cast investment

Efficiency Factors:

- Single primary location (The Peach Pit) reduces costs
 - Natural Atlanta backdrop provides production value
 - Food content creates built-in marketing materials
 - Limited special effects or complex action sequences
-

STORY & HOOK – WHY THIS STORY MATTERS NOW

In an era of performative relationships and social media facades, *Southern (Dis)Comfort* offers authentic connection. As audiences crave genuine cultural representation and meaningful romantic storytelling, this film delivers both.

The story taps into current conversations about:

- **Generational trauma and healing**
- **Authentic cultural expression vs. appropriation**
- **Food as cultural identity and love language**
- **Second chances in cancel culture era**
- **Building real connections in digital age**

Post-pandemic, audiences hunger for stories about community, family chosen and biological, and the healing power of sharing meals together.

DEMOGRAPHICS

Core Viewership Projections:

- **Women 25-54:** 40% of audience
- **Men 25-54:** 25% of audience
- **Adults 18-34:** 25% of audience
- **Adults 55+:** 10% of audience

Geographic Appeal:

- **Southern markets:** 35% above national average
- **Urban markets:** Strong performance expected
- **International:** Food culture universality drives global appeal

Psychographic Targets:

- Food culture enthusiasts
 - Authentic storytelling seekers
 - Romance genre loyalists
 - Cultural representation advocates
-

MARKETABILITY

Streaming Platform Fit:

- **Netflix:** Rom-com track record, diverse content initiative
- **Amazon Prime:** Prestige original content, awards positioning
- **Apple TV+:** Quality over quantity, cultural authenticity focus
- **Paramount+:** Southern culture connection, BET crossover potential
- **OWN:** Perfect brand alignment, authentic Black storytelling

Marketing Advantages:

1. **Food Content:** Built-in social media marketing through recipe content
2. **Atlanta Setting:** Local market enthusiasm, tourism tie-ins
3. **Cast Appeal:** Strong social media followings, interview-ready personalities
4. **Cultural Moment:** Authentic representation during industry diversity push
5. **Genre Hunger:** Underserved rom-com audience seeking quality content

Ancillary Revenue:

- Cookbook tie-in opportunities
 - Atlanta restaurant partnerships
 - Cooking class experiences
 - Streaming cooking show spin-offs
 - Merchandise through food/kitchen products
-

THE BOTTOM LINE

Southern (Dis)Comfort serves up everything streaming audiences are hungry for: authentic cultural storytelling, gorgeous food cinematography, genuine romantic chemistry, and universal themes of family, forgiveness, and finding home. With the right cast and marketing push, this has all the ingredients for both critical acclaim and commercial success.

This isn't just a movie... it's a meal that satisfies on every level.